UX
MENTORSHIP

Gurully

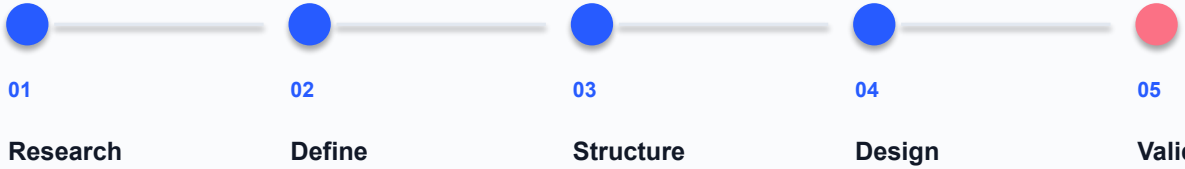
A practical case study from problem → product

Research • strategy • flow • wireframes • UI • prototype

UX DESIGN PROCESS

Designing a clearer path to the target score.

This deck is built as a teaching case study — every visual decision is tied back to a UX decision.



Gurully public product context • concept redesign

Start with the problem, not the pixels.

A feature-rich exam-prep product needs to feel simple at the moment of decision.

> **“I know there are lots of things I can do. I’m not sure what I should do first.”**

CASE QUESTION

How might we help a learner move from target score → right practice → useful feedback → next action?

Clarity | Momentum | Confidence

Gurully already has the ingredients.

The UX opportunity is to orchestrate them into a clearer learning loop.

2M+
students guided

91+
countries

30k+
practice questions

4
exam ecosystems

PTE
Practice • mock • score

IELTS
Practice • mock • score

DET
Practice • mock • score

CELPIP
Practice • mock • score

Public product facts used as context; UX findings below are framed as hypotheses unless validated.

Triangulate before you redesign.

Use evidence from three angles — product, people and behaviour.

01

SECONDARY

Product audit
Competitor scan
Public reviews

What it tells us

What exists

02

PRIMARY

Interviews
Task observation
Survey

What it tells us

What users struggle with

03

VALIDATION

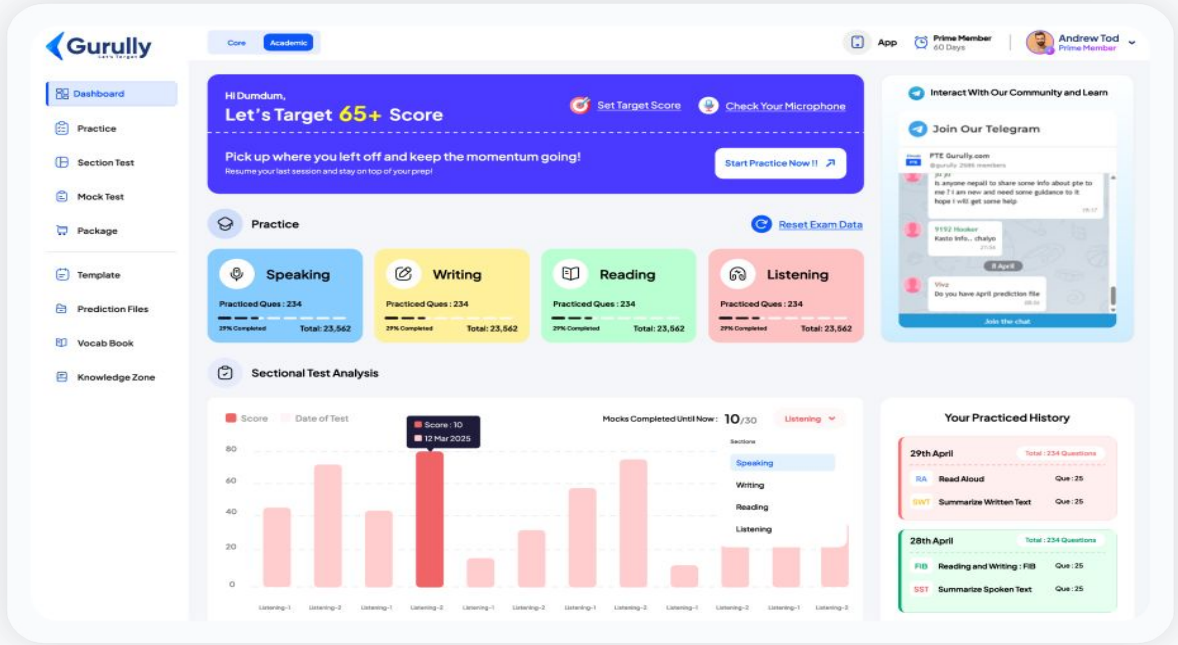
Usability test
Prototype comparison
Metrics

What it tells us

Whether the design works

The current experience is powerful — but dense.

A useful audit separates “has a feature” from “makes the feature easy to use.”



Public Gurully dashboard example — used as product evidence.

WHAT I WOULD AUDIT

01 Findability

Can users locate the right practice mode quickly?

02 Hierarchy

Is the next best action obvious?

03 Feedback

Does a score explain what to do next?

04 Cognitive load

How many decisions compete on one screen?

Five hypotheses worth testing.

These are not “research findings” yet. They are testable beliefs.

H1 **Users need a goal-first entry point.**

H2 **A raw score is less useful than a recommended next action.**

H3 **Progress should be visible without visiting a separate analytics area.**

H4 **The product should progressively reveal its breadth.**

H5 **Practice and feedback should feel like one continuous loop.**

Meet the learner we are designing for.

A proto-persona keeps the workshop concrete until primary research replaces assumptions.

THE OPTIMISER

Aarav

24 • PTE • target 79

**“I don’t need more content.
I need to know what will move my score.”**

GOAL	**Reach 79+ before exam day.**
FRUSTRATION	**Too many practice choices.**
NEED	**A clear weak-area diagnosis.**
SUCCESS	**Every session tells me what to do next.**

The emotional dip happens after the score.

That is where the product can shift from evaluator → coach.

Discover

curious

Start

uncertain

Test

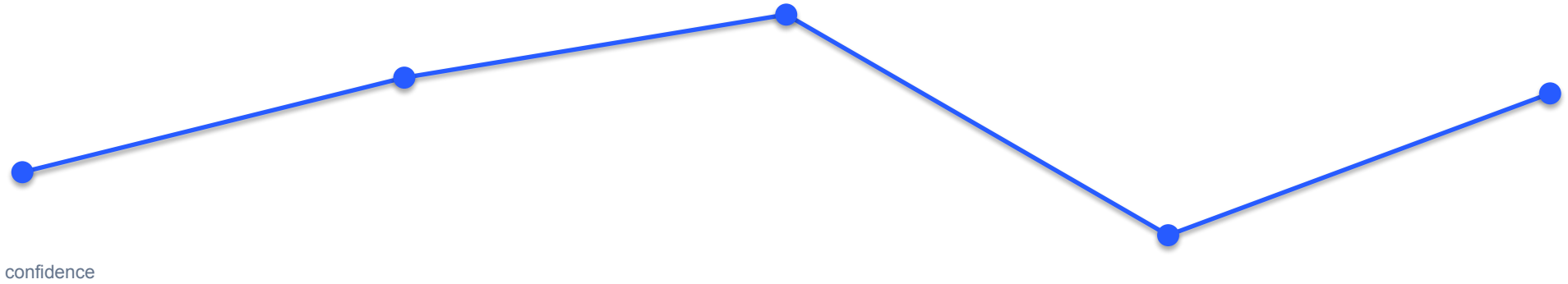
focused

Result

vulnerable

Improve

motivated



UX opportunity

Explain the score → prioritise the gap → start the next practice.

The job is bigger than “take a mock test.”

Functional, emotional and progress jobs shape the experience.

01

FUNCTIONAL

Assess my readiness against a target score.

Measure

02

EMOTIONAL

Reduce uncertainty before the real exam.

Feel

03

PROGRESS

Tell me what to practise next.

Improve

One problem statement. One HMW.

Good UX gets narrower before it gets wider.

PROBLEM

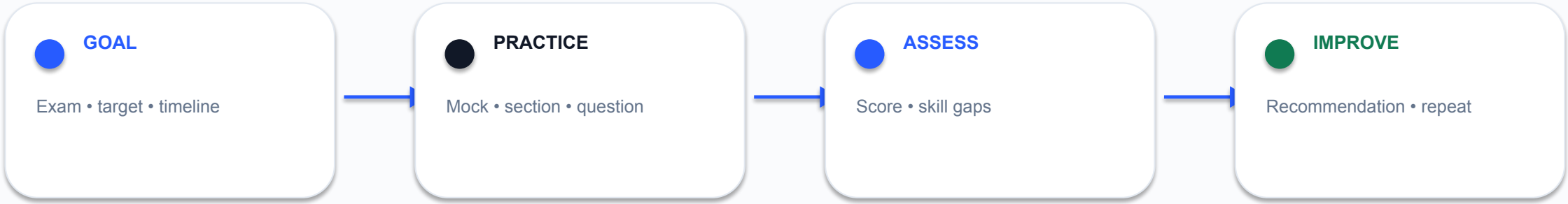
Test-takers can access many preparation features, but may not know which action best fits their goal and current readiness.

HOW MIGHT WE

...guide users from target score → right practice → useful feedback → next action with minimal cognitive load?

Structure the product around intent.

The mental model becomes: Goal → Practice → Assess → Improve.



Design rule

If a feature does not help the learner move through this loop, it should not compete for primary attention.

Design the happy path first.

Edge cases come after the primary journey works.

01

Set target

Goal + score

02

Choose practice

Right difficulty

03

Take test

Low-distraction

04

See score

Explain gaps

05

Act on feedback

Next practice

Critical transition

RESULT → NEXT ACTION

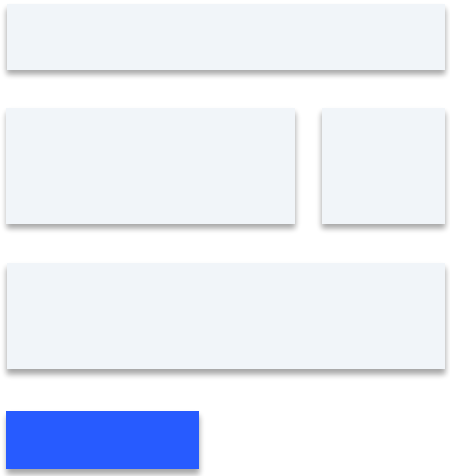
The score page should not become a dead end.

Low fidelity: prove hierarchy before decoration.

Four screens. Four questions.

01

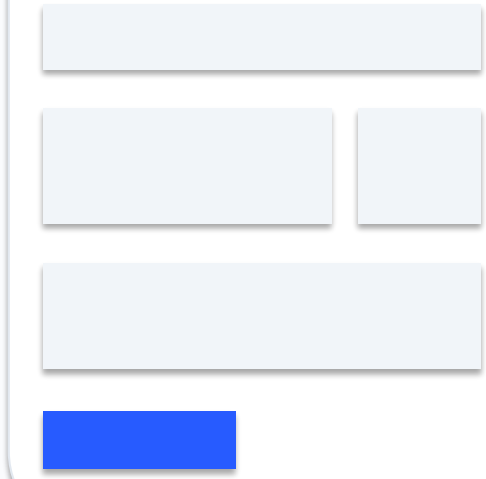
HOME



What am I preparing for?

02

DASHBOARD



What should I do next?

03

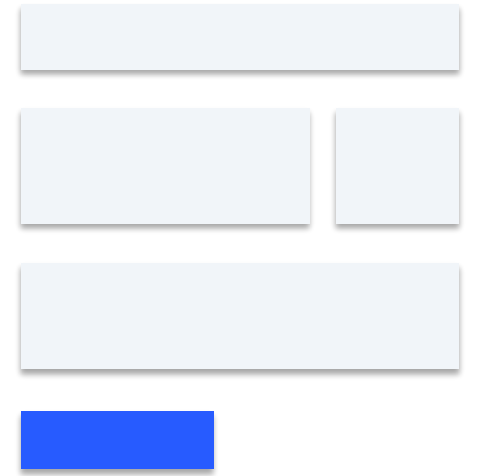
MOCK



Can I stay focused?

04

RESULT



Why did I get this score?

Minimal UI needs a disciplined system.

Use one strong primary, one support colour and lots of air.

PRIMARY
#275BFF

INK
#111827

SURFACE
#FAFBFD

SUCCESS
#107A52

FOCUS
#FB7185

Aa

Aptos Display / Aptos

32 / 24 / 16 / 12

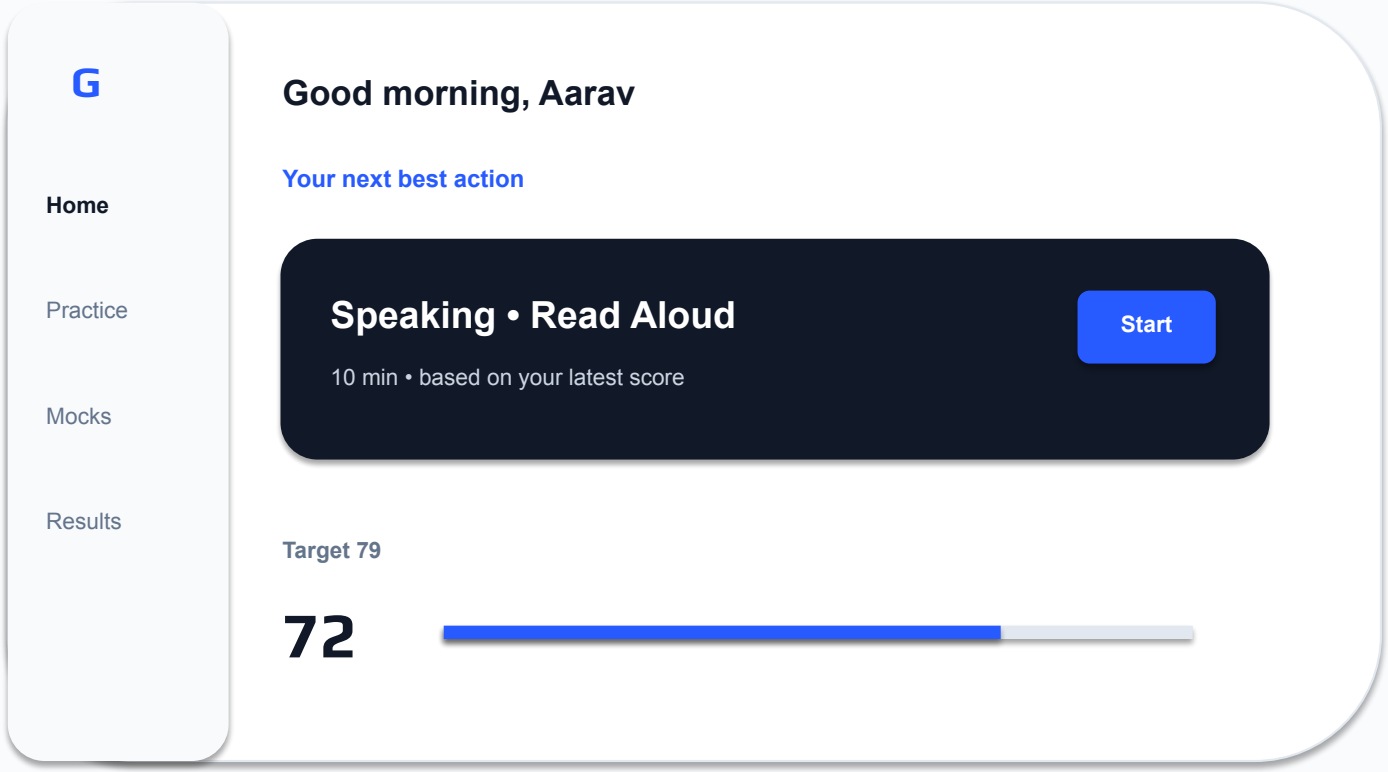
8 pt 16 pt 24 pt 32 pt

Radius **12–16 px**

Rule **Air > decoration**

Concept 01 — Goal-first dashboard.

The first screen should answer one question: what should I do next?



WHY

Reduce the decision surface.

The dashboard is not a menu. It is a coach: target → readiness → next action.

Progressive disclosure

Concept 02 — Results that teach.

A score is only useful when it changes what the learner does next.

OVERALL SCORE

72

Target 79

TARGET GAP

7 pts

SKILL SNAPSHOT



NEXT BEST ACTION

Improve Speaking first

10 min practice

Practice

Prototype the moments where confidence breaks.

Don’t prototype every page. Prototype the transitions that matter.

01

Goal → Practice

Does the learner know why this is recommended?

TEST

Choice + confidence

02

Practice → Result

Is completion and feedback immediate?

TEST

Continuity + trust

03

Result → Improve

Can the learner act without hunting?

TEST

Action + relevance

Test behaviour, not opinions.

Give users realistic tasks and watch what they do.

TASK 01	**You need 79 in PTE. Start preparing.**	Measure time to first practice.
TASK 02	**Your latest score is 72. What would you do next?**	Measure result comprehension.
TASK 03	**Show me how you know whether you are improving.**	Measure progress discoverability.

5–8 representative users Enough to expose recurring interaction problems in a focused prototype test.

If the UX works, behaviour should change.

Measure the health of the preparation loop.

Activation

Goal setup → first practice

↓ time to first action

Engagement

Repeat practice / mock completion

↑ meaningful sessions

Learning

Weak-area practice adoption

↑ targeted improvement

Business

Free → paid conversion

↑ qualified conversion

The whole UX story, in one frame.

This is the narrative your mentees should learn to reproduce.

EVIDENCE	INSIGHT	OPPORTUNITY	DESIGN	VALIDATION
The product offers breadth.	Breadth can increase decision load.	Guide the learner through a focused loop.	Goal-first dashboard + teaching results.	Test activation, comprehension and next action.

The portfolio lesson

Every polished screen should be the visible consequence of an earlier UX decision.

MENTOR WORKSHOP

Now make your mentees do it.

Give them the same product and remove the final UI. Make them earn the pixels.

01 **Audit**

Find 3 UX frictions

02 **Research**

Write 5 questions

03 **Synthesis**

Create 3 insights

04 **Flow**

Design the happy path

05 **Wireframe**

Prove hierarchy

06 **UI**

Design 1 key screen

Rule: no UI until you can explain the problem it solves.

Sources, assumptions & research integrity.

A good case study is honest about what is known, inferred and still needs validation.

PUBLIC PRODUCT SOURCES

Gurully website
PTE practice / mock-test pages
Public product screenshots and articles
Public reviews / testimonials

DESIGN ASSUMPTIONS

Personas = proto-personas
Research insights = hypotheses until tested
Redesign = concept, not shipped-product claim
Metrics = proposed success measures

Teaching principle: never manufacture evidence to make a case study look complete.

The UX story, closed.

A good redesign is not about adding more features. It is about making the existing product easier to understand, easier to act on, and easier to learn from.

01

UNDERSTAND

Research the learner, the product and the market.

02

FOCUS

Turn evidence into a clear problem and a focused user journey.

03

DESIGN

Create a goal-first flow, simple information architecture and purposeful UI.

04

VALIDATE

Test whether the experience improves clarity, confidence and action.

THE CORE IDEA

From feature discovery → to guided preparation.

Goal → Practice → Assess → Improve

MENTOR TAKEAWAY

Every polished screen should be the visible consequence of a UX decision.